

The Alps

The mountains of the Alps divide the cooler northern parts of Europe from the warm southern parts. With mountain lakes, glaciers, meadows, and forests, there are plenty of places for different animals to live. As many as 30,000 different species make their home here.

Location

The Alps stretch through eight countries in total. The highest parts are always snowy, but in summer lower parts can reach 86° F (30° C).

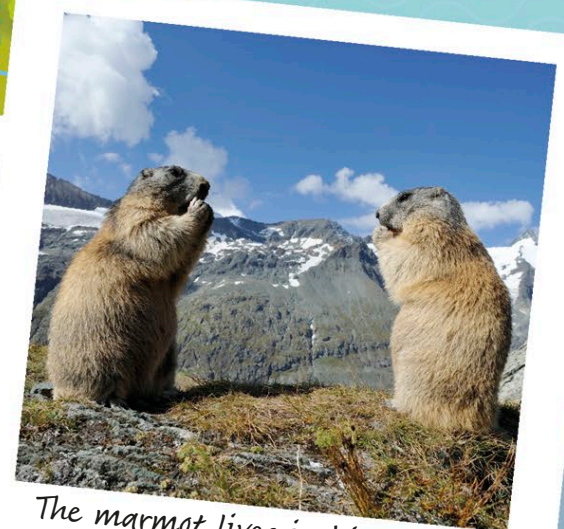


Pine marten

Powerful forelimbs and strong claws make martens excellent climbers. They even race through the trees to hunt squirrels.

Alpine marmot

The alpine marmot digs long, deep burrows where it hibernates for up to nine months of the year. When hibernating, a marmot breathes just one to two times a minute!



The marmot lives in high alpine meadows and pastures.